

# RUNDONG WANG

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## Education

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University of British Columbia

2022 Sep – Present; *Expected Graduation: 2027 May*

**Major:** B.A. Cognitive Systems — Cognition and Brain Stream

**Minor:** Philosophy

**Thesis:** Beyond STORM: Preserved Action Perception in Autism

**Relevant Graduate Coursework:** PHIL 551A: Philosophy of Mind (enrolled)

## Research Interests

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Broadly, the interaction between *mind and world*: how the mind engages an environment that is dynamic, social, and always encountered from a point of view

- **Time and dynamics.** How the visual system summarizes and segments continuously changing input — ensemble perception in dynamic scenes, event boundaries, and the construal of lived & experienced time itself
- **Social cognition.** How observers read and anticipate the actions of other agents, and how this varies across situations & individual differences
- **Neurophenomenology.** How the "point of view" is manifested; to understand the basis of human, we have to voyage to the phenomenon of "lived being"

## Awards & Funding

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**Work Learn International Undergraduate Research Award**

2026

Faculty of Arts, University of British Columbia — \$8,700

**Work Learn Program** – upcoming

2026 – 2027

University of British Columbia

## Research Experience

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**Research Assistant (Work Learn)**

2026 September – 2027 May

↔ Dr. Joan Ongchoco & Dr. Hee Yeon Im

*Perception & Cognition Lab / Interactive Mind & Movement Lab*

- Upcoming

**Lab Manager & Research Assistant (Work Learn)**

2026 May – 2026 September

↔ Dr. Hee Yeon Im

*Interactive Mind & Movement Lab*

- Full time hire in summer, managed day-to-day lab operations, including participant scheduling, data and equipment organization, and onboarding and training of incoming research assistants
- Maintained and extended a MATLAB/EEGLAB preprocessing pipeline (dual-filter design, rank-aware ICA, ICLabel component classification) used across multiple ongoing EEG studies
- Conducted MEG preprocessing and analysis in MNE-Python, independently adapting the lab pipeline to new study designs
- Coordinated stimulus preparation and experimental design refinement across concurrent lab projects
- Supervised and mentored two Indigenous high school students through the SeedToStem program, providing hands-on training in research methods and literature review

**Research Assistant & Directed Study Student**

2025 Sep – 2026 May

↔ Dr. Hee Yeon Im

*Interactive Mind & Movement Lab*

- Worked across three concurrent projects: (A) ensemble coding with dynamic videos (lead), (B) ego-moving vs. time-moving time perception, and (C) field-of-view (FOV) effects on ensemble coding in driving contexts
- Led one project end-to-end: developed hypotheses, designed paradigms, built and iterated tasks, and coordinated analysis plans with the team
- Built experimental and data analysis pipelines using *PsychoPy*, *JavaScript*, *Python*, *MATLAB*, and *R*; implemented stimulus preparation, timing checks, and data logging
- Conducted mouse-tracking analysis and behavioral modeling; translated results into discussion points for lab meetings

## Research Assistant

↔ Dr. Rebecca Todd & Joey Manaligod (PhD Student)

2025 Apr – 2026 May

Motivated Cognition Lab

- Preprocessed and synchronized multi-modal physiological data (ECG, accelerometer, gyroscope, heart rate) for a study on joint social cognition
- Led statistical analysis in *R* and *Python*, including mixed-effects models and visualization of group-level effects; contributed findings to lab discussions
- Refined study design during the pilot phase; administered sessions and supported participant testing

## Research Assistant & Undergraduate Thesis Student

↔ Dr. James T. Enns & Dr. Veronica Dudarev

2024 Mar – Present

UBC Vision Lab

- Examined action prediction in autistic vs. neurotypical observers using a Choice vs. Directed pointing paradigm with manipulations of visual load (1 vs. 3 actors) and response mapping (same- vs. opposite-side)
- Modeled and visualized behavioral outcomes in *R*; used *inverse efficiency score (IES)* to integrate response time and accuracy into a single performance metric
- Conducted behavioral testing and questionnaire administration with neurodivergent participants; supported study execution and lab operations

## Manuscripts in Prep

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Dudarev, V., Wang, R., & Enns, J. T. (2026). *Beyond storm: Preserved action perception in autism*(working title) [Manuscript in preparation].

Wang, R., Cui, V., Purba, G., & Im, H. Y. (2026). *Reading the room over time: Extracting and updating emotional ensemble representations from dynamic groups*(working title) [Manuscript in preparation].

## Presentations & Conferences

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Purba, G., Wang, R., Cui, V., Fong, A., Villa, P. R., & Im, H. Y. (2026). Reading the room over time: Extracting and updating emotional ensemble representations from dynamic groups [Poster presented at the North West Cognition and Memory (NOWCAM), May 2026].

Wang, R., Dudarev, V., & Enns, J. T. (2026a). Beyond storm: Preserved action perception in autism [Poster presented at the Psychology Undergraduate Research Conference (PURC), April 2026].

Wang, R., Dudarev, V., & Enns, J. T. (2026b). Beyond storm: Preserved action perception in autism [Poster presented at the North West Cognition and Memory (NOWCAM), May 2026].

## Public Talk

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Wang, R. (2026). Confused temporal consciousness: Discussion from many angles [Invited speaker presented at the Boozy Lecture Series; talks about the mis-understood temporal consciousness in research coming from arguments rooted in Phenomenology (Husserl, Merleau-Ponty)].

## Teaching Experience

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Teaching Assistant *COGS 200: Introduction to Cognitive Systems*

2027 Jan – Apr

- Contract signed, upcoming term.

Teaching Assistant *COGS 300: Understanding and Designing Cognitive Systems*

2026 Jan – Apr

- Co-designed and co-delivered a lecture on \*input-to-meaning\* processing, connecting course concepts to findings in psychology and neuroscience
- Facilitated hands-on robotics labs; helped students build circuits, integrate sensors/actuators, and debug hardware and embedded C/C++ code using Arduino and Processing
- Graded and delivered structured written feedback on Design Solutions and other coursework
- Held office hours and responded asynchronously via Piazza; supported course logistics through Canvas

Statistics Tutor *PSYC 218: Analysis of Behavioural Data*

2025 Jan – 2026 Apr

- Provided support in statistics, research-method interpretation, and analysis workflows (e.g., SPSS)
- Led one-on-one and group tutoring sessions; helped students debug and communicate results clearly

Service & Professional Development

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| MEG Summer Camp                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <i>Simon Fraser University</i>                             | 2026 August    |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Intensive training in MEG acquisition, preprocessing, source analysis, and machine learning; organized by <i>Dr. Alex Wiesman</i></li></ul>                                 |                                                            |                |
| Associate Editor                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <i>Canadian Undergraduate Journal of Cognitive Science</i> | 2025 Mar – Nov |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Reviewed and provided detailed feedback on submitted manuscripts</li><li>Participated in editorial meetings and contributed to the journal’s publication strategy</li></ul> |                                                            |                |

Skills & Certifications

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| Programming Languages        | MATLAB, Python, JavaScript, C++, Bash                          |
| Data & Statistics            | R (tidyverse, ggplot2, afex, lme4, mousetrap), SPSS            |
| Experiment & Analysis Tools  | PsychoPy, Psychtoolbox, EEGLAB, MNE-Python, Simulink, jsPsych  |
| Hardware/Prototyping         | Arduino, eye tracking (Gazepoint), LSL, heart rate (Movesense) |
| Media & Stimulus Preparation | FFmpeg, Adobe Premiere Pro, After Effects, Photoshop           |
| Version Control & Writing    | Git/GitHub, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X                    |
| Languages                    | English, Mandarin Chinese, Japanese (beginner)                 |